

★ Gold Shuffle setup guide

October 8, 2026

Gold Shuffle gives Spotify a true-random shuffle: every song in a playlist gets a number, the numbers are shuffled so every order is equally likely, and every song gets its turn. Setup takes about 5 minutes per device.

How it works

- **Why Spotify's shuffle repeats itself:** Spotify's shuffle isn't purely random. It weights songs, so the same handful keep coming up.
- **What gold shuffle does instead:** it numbers every song in the playlist and shuffles the numbers with a method called Fisher-Yates. Every possible order is equally likely, so every song gets its turn.
- **How it plays:** Gold Shuffle doesn't play music itself. It reads the playlist, works out the order, and tells the Spotify app what to play next, one song at a time. That's why it can handle playlists of any size, and why it stays out of your own queue.
- **Why setup has extra steps:** Spotify only lets an app control playback if the app is registered with Spotify. Part 2 is that registration.

What you need

- **Spotify Premium.** Spotify only lets apps control playback for Premium accounts.
- **Android phone:** the Gold Shuffle app (`GoldShuffle-<build>.apk`), sent to you directly.
- **PC:** the Spotify desktop app plus the `goldShuffle.js` file. Works on Windows, Mac and Linux.
- There's no iPhone version yet.

Android, part 1: install the app

1. Open the `GoldShuffle-<build>.apk` file on your phone.
2. When Android asks, allow your browser or messaging app to install unknown apps, then tap **Install**.
3. Open Gold Shuffle. It shows a setup screen with every value from part 2 and a **Copy** button next to each.

Updates install over the old version and keep you signed in.

Android, part 2: make your own Spotify developer app

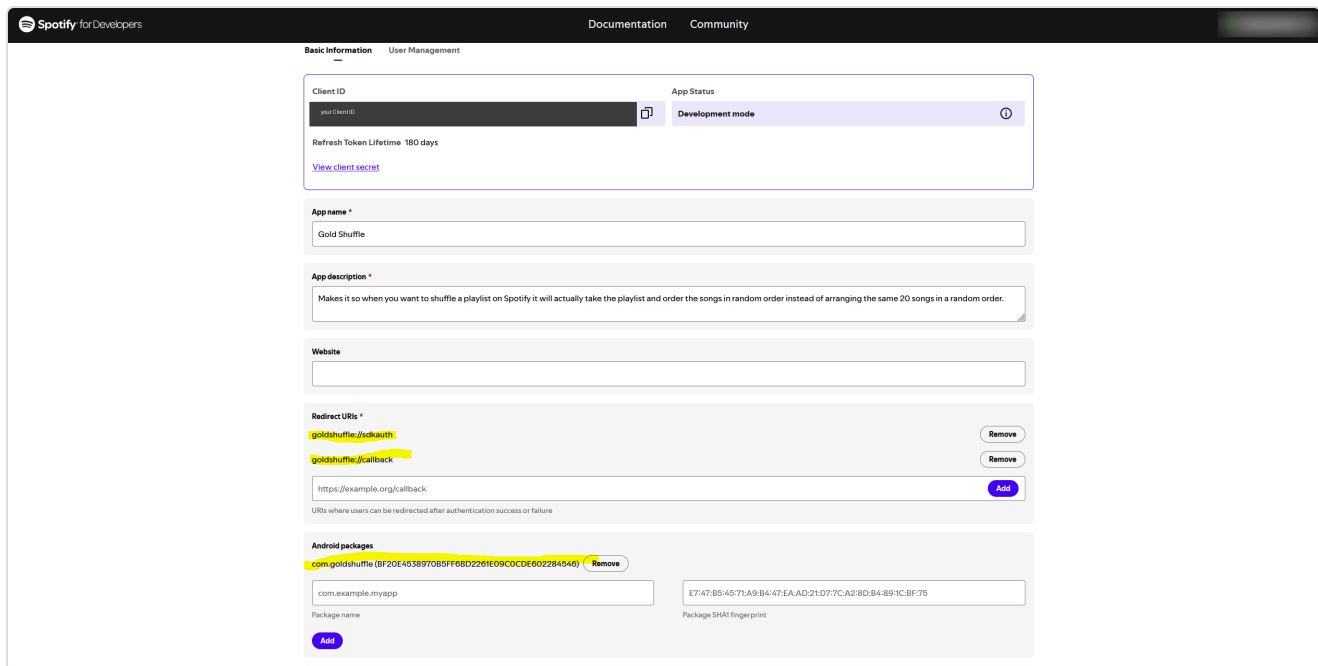
This registration is called a developer app, and the **Client ID** it gives you is how Spotify knows which registered app is asking. It's free, it uses your normal Spotify login, and it takes about 2 minutes.

How many people can share one Client ID: up to **5 Spotify accounts** per developer app, and the app's owner needs Premium. To share yours, add each friend's name and Spotify email under **User Management** on your dashboard; they then paste your Client ID into the app. For more than 5 people, each person makes their own developer app, which has no shared limit.

1. Go to developer.spotify.com/dashboard, log in, accept the terms and click **Create app**. Name and description can be anything.
2. Under **Redirect URIs**, add both values from the table below.
3. Under **Which API/SDKs**, tick **Web API** and **Android**.
4. Under **Android packages**, fill in the package name and SHA1 fingerprint, then press the purple **Add** button. It's easy to miss, and nothing works without it.
5. Click **Save** at the bottom.
6. Open your app's **Settings**, copy the **Client ID** (not the Client Secret), and paste it into Gold Shuffle.

Dashboard field	Value
Redirect URI 1	goldshuffle://callback
Redirect URI 2	goldshuffle://sdkauth
Android package name	com.goldshuffle
Android SHA1 fingerprint	BF:20:E4:53:89:70:B5:FF:6B:D2:26:1E:09:C0:CD:E6:02:28:45:46

What a finished setup looks like. The highlighted parts are what you fill in: both redirect URIs, and the Android package saved as a line with a **Remove** button next to it. If your package and fingerprint are still sitting in the input boxes, you haven't pressed **Add** yet.



Spotify developer dashboard with both redirect URIs and the Android package saved

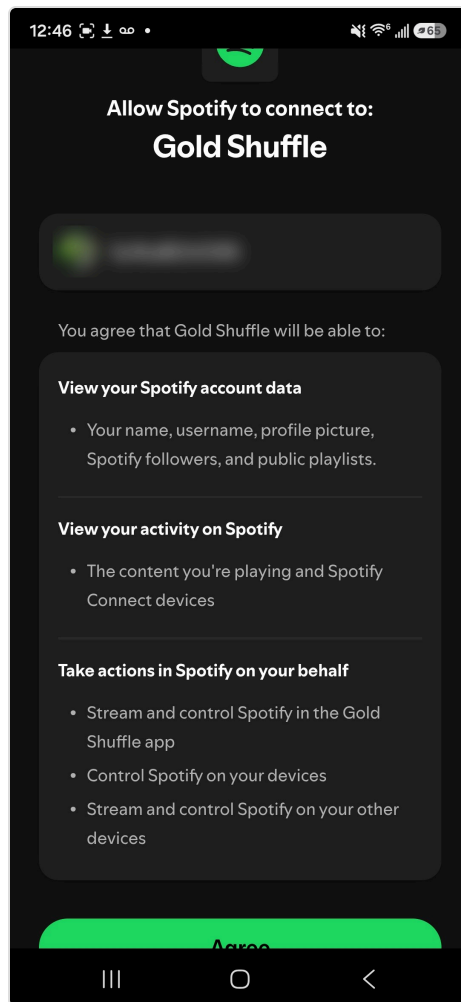
The app's setup screen shows the same values with Copy buttons, and reads the fingerprint from the app itself, so trust the app if the two ever differ.

Android, part 3: sign in and use it

1. Tap **Sign in with Spotify** and approve.
2. Approve the second Spotify prompt. It connects Gold Shuffle to the Spotify app on your phone.
3. Allow notifications if asked. The notification holds the **Stop** button.

Why two prompts: the first lets Gold Shuffle read your playlists and control playback over the internet. The second connects it directly to the Spotify app on your phone. That direct connection is what lets it read playlists you only follow, and keep working when you lose signal.

The second prompt looks like this, with your own account at the top. Tap **Agree**.



Spotify's "Allow Spotify to connect to Gold Shuffle" screen

To do this	Tap
Reshuffle what's playing (the current song keeps playing)	★ Gold shuffle what's playing
Start a playlist, album or Liked Songs in a gold order	The playlist in the list
One-tap reshuffle from the home screen	Long-press the icon → Gold shuffle now
Stop	Stop gold shuffle , or Stop on the notification

- **Any playlist works**, including ones you follow but didn't make.
- **Offline**: a playlist marked **📶** is saved on the phone. With **Offline-ready** on (the default), Gold Shuffle keeps working if you lose signal, as long as it connected while you were online.
- **Your queue is left alone**. Songs you queue yourself play normally. Only one Gold Shuffle song waits in the queue, and leftovers are skipped when you switch playlists.

PC: add gold to Spotify's shuffle button

This uses Spicetify, a free tool that adds extensions to the Spotify desktop app. The shuffle button then cycles **gold** → **shuffle** → **smart shuffle** → **off**.

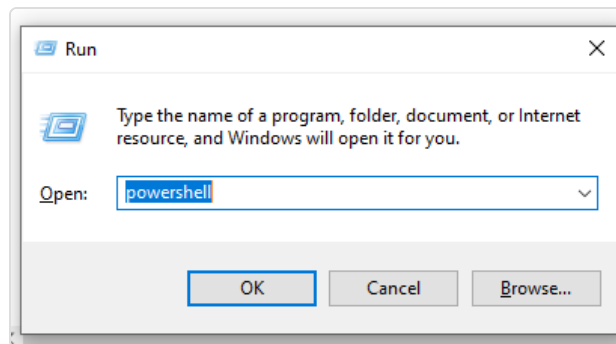
Why Spicetify: the Spotify desktop app is built from web code, and Spicetify adds small scripts to it, like a browser extension. `goldShuffle.js` is one of those scripts. It takes over the shuffle button, adds the gold step, and leaves Spotify's own shuffle and smart shuffle as they were. The `backup` step saves a clean copy of Spotify first, so it can always be restored.

Open PowerShell (Windows)

PowerShell is the window where you type commands. You only need it for setup.

1. Press the **Windows key** (or click Start).
2. Type `powershell`.
3. Click **Windows PowerShell** in the results. A dark blue window opens with a line ending in `>`.

Shortcut: press **Windows key + R**, type `powershell`, and click **OK**.



The Windows Run box with "powershell" typed in

To run a command: copy it from this guide, **right-click** inside the PowerShell window to paste it (Ctrl+V works too on newer Windows), then press **Enter**. Wait for it to finish before pasting the next one.

On a Mac, open **Terminal** instead: press **Cmd+Space**, type `terminal`, press **Enter**. Paste with **Cmd+V**.

Install Spicetify and Gold Shuffle

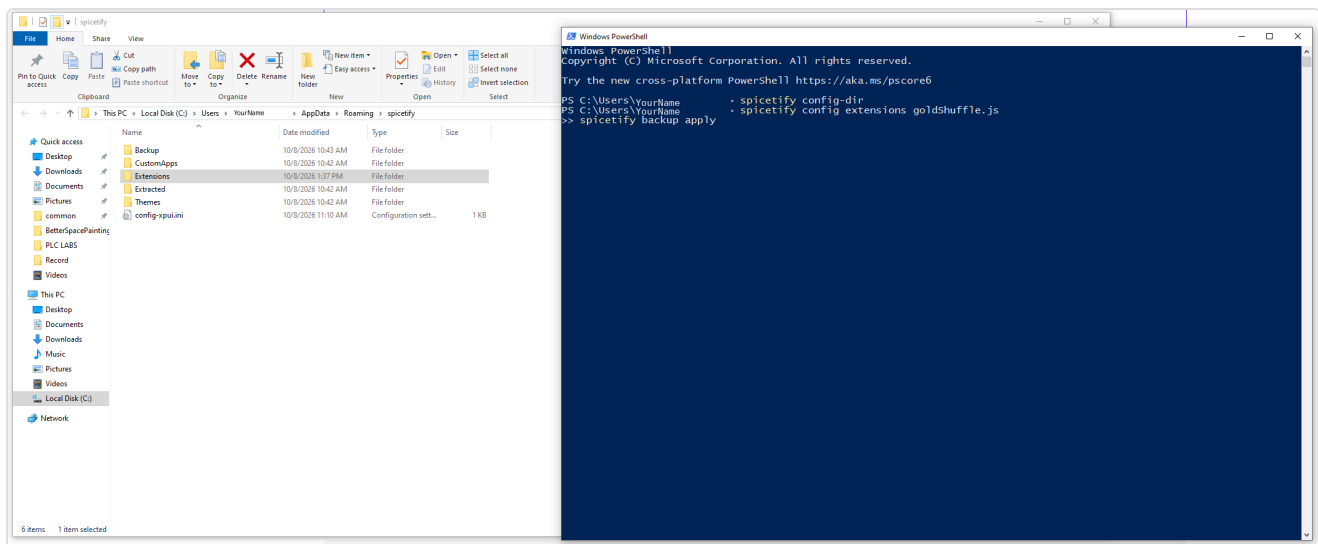
1. Close Spotify completely.
2. Paste this into PowerShell and press **Enter** (Mac/Linux: use the command on spicetify.app instead):

```
iwr -useb https://raw.githubusercontent.com/spicetify/cli/main/install.ps1 | iex
```

3. If it asks about installing the **Marketplace**, type **n** and press **Enter**. Gold Shuffle doesn't need it.
4. **Close PowerShell and open it again**, so it recognizes the new `spicetify` command.
5. Run `spicetify config-dir`. A folder opens. Put `goldShuffle.js` into the **Extensions** folder inside it.
6. Run these two commands, one at a time:

```
spicetify config extensions goldShuffle.js
spicetify backup apply
```

After `spicetify config-dir`, the spicetify folder opens (left). Put `goldShuffle.js` inside **Extensions**. On the right is PowerShell with the commands typed in. If a line starts with `>>`, two commands were pasted together; paste one at a time instead.



The spicetify folder in File Explorer next to PowerShell showing the setup commands

7. Spotify restarts and shows **Gold Shuffle ready**. Play a playlist and click shuffle: it turns gold.

Spotify updates sometimes remove the mod. Run `spicetify apply` to bring it back. Modifying the desktop app is against Spotify's terms, so use it at your own risk.

Troubleshooting

What you see	Fix
<code>AUTHENTICATION_SERVICE_UNAVAILABLE</code>	The Android package isn't saved on your dashboard. Redo part 2, steps 4–5 (press Add , then Save), then sign out and back in.
Sign-in fails or says the redirect URI is invalid	Both redirect URIs must be added exactly as written, with no spaces.
A playlist you follow won't load	Approve the second Spotify prompt. Followed playlists are read through the Spotify app.
Nothing happens offline	Open Gold Shuffle once while online with Offline-ready on, and gold-shuffle the playlist once so it's saved (⌵).
"Spotify isn't open on any device"	Open Spotify, play anything for a second, then try again.
PC: the shuffle button isn't gold	Run <code>spicetify apply</code> and look for Gold Shuffle ready when Spotify starts.